

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.3. 17th of March 2025



FAITH COMES - FAITH TURNS UP - FAITH APPEARS - FAITH ENTERS

Romans 10:17 So faith comes from what is heard, and what is heard comes through the message about Christ. Holman

Romans 10:17 The point is, before you trust, you have to listen. But unless Christ's Word is preached, there's nothing to listen to. THE MESSAGE:

Cometh, comes = the Greek Word *Erchomai* translated means "Come" or appear

LISTENING EARS ARE CONDITIONAL ON HAVING A SENSITIVE HEART OPEN FOR DIRECTION AND INSTRUCTION – (the opposite to a hardened heart)

HEARTS THAT ARE DULL OF HEARING

Matthew 13:15-16

*15 For the hearts of these people are **hardened**, and their ears cannot hear, and they have closed their eyes— so their eyes cannot see, and their ears cannot hear, and their hearts cannot understand, and they cannot turn to me and let me heal them.'*

HAVING EARS, THAT CANNOT HEAR - and that do not remember

Mark 8:17-18

*17 And when Jesus knew it, he saith unto them, Why reason ye, because ye have no bread? perceive ye not yet, neither understand? **have ye your heart yet hardened?***

*18 Having eyes, see ye not? and **having ears, hear ye not?** and do ye not remember? KJV*

*Ezekiel 12:2 "Son of man, you are living among a **rebellious** people. They have eyes to see but do not see and **ears to hear but do not hear**, for they are **a rebellious people**. NIV*

FAITH WILL COME IF WE ARE PREPARED TO LISTEN

LISTENING MEANS TO ACTUALLY WANT TO HEAR WHAT IS BEING SAID OR WRITTEN.

WE MUST HAVE A LISTENING EAR.

ARE WE REALLY HEARING / LISTENING?

Are we reaching out / straining to "hear" and understand what it is really being said or written?

Are we **filtering** the scriptures by the way we think or interpret it or from what we have heard others teach and thus missing what its real message is?

FROM MY PERSONAL EXPERIENCE

I have read some scriptures many times over but only when I have seriously asked God / the Spirit to show me what I have not yet seen about scripture and then it comes alive with new meaning an understanding.

And this produces a fresh desire to live it – to apply it to my life

In the following story we note that the disciples failed to "hear" what Jesus said to do –

Mark 4:35 As evening came, Jesus said to his disciples, "Let's cross to the other side of the lake." NLT

Mark 4:35 "Let us go over to the other side." NIV

Mark 4:35-41 read all the story

But notice verse 40 "He said to his disciples, "Why are you so afraid? Do you still have no faith?"

They heard what Jesus said which was a definite statement "Let US (including Jesus himself) cross to the other side of the lake.

but they missed the main implications of those words

If Jesus said **let US go**, then their faith should have arisen to have confidence in that it was the Lord who said that and he is going to be WITH us.

Do you still have no faith?" -

This did not mean the disciples had no faith at all but because they did not "hear" or understand the full implications of Jesus statement to them - faith was absent.

FAITH WAS MISSING. It was out of the way

FAITH WAS NOT PRESENT when needed because they failed to really understand what Jesus said. He meant that they all would be going together to the other side of the Lake.

FAITH WOULD HAVE SAID we believe in what Jesus said and therefore we will not be afraid that we might perish or die".

This is indicated in the following translation

Romans 10:14 But not all lent an obedient ear to the good news. For Isaiah says, Lord, who believed our message?

So then, **faith is out of the source of that which is heard**, and that which is heard [the message] is through the agency of the Word concerning Christ. Kenneth S. Wuest

FAITH IS AN UNDESERVED TRUST IN THE INTEGRITY AND CHARACTER OF GOD AND WHAT HE HAS SAID / PROMISED

God has stated that through Christ's redemptive work on Christ he has freely justified us and brought us into right standing with himself, then how is it possible for us to continue to think of ourselves poorly, having no Identity, value and worth.

To do so reveals that we have **not really "heard"** what his message is through Christ. How many times have we **failed to "hear"** what **God's word says about US**, but we continue to think differently?

- **God's word says** that we are his purchased possession – redeemed, bought by his blood how is it we **fail to hear his message** that he will take good care of us.
- **God's word says** he is for us so do **we hear his message** that he is not against us and who will prevail over us.
- **God's word says** that he will never leave us or forsake us, **but have we really heard what he means**; it means that he is always with US. So how can we doubt and believe differently? (Hebrews 13:5)
- **God's word says** that we are a new creation created in Christ Jesus the old has gone and the new has come - **have we really heard what that means** so that it dramatically affects our behaviour, how we think and act.
- **God's word says** that through faith we have peace WITH God through our lord Jesus Christ – if we have truly heard this message, then it will mean **that we understand** that God is no longer angry with us, and his enemy – because now through Christ we have peace WITH God and HE is with us.

IF WE TRULY HEAR – LISTEN TO THE WORD OF GOD EMBRACE GOD'S WORD THROUGH THE MESSAGE OF CHRIST FAITH WILL COME.

FAITH WILL APPEAR.

FAITH WILL TURN UP.

And it will strengthen us, inspires us, give us godly confidence.

LET US HAVE LISTENING EARS.

Amen – Ps Barry